Main Idea & Supporting Details | Set 2

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Part A - Find the Best Main Idea (4 questions)

Read each paragraph. Underline the sentence that best expresses its main idea, if one is stated. Then circle the best answer. Some main ideas are implied rather than stated directly.

1. The Community Garden

The empty lot beside Maple Street School was once covered with weeds and litter. Last spring, neighbors decided to turn it into a community garden. Families cleared the rubbish, built raised beds, and planted vegetables. Students now visit after school to water seedlings and learn about insects. At harvest time, volunteers share fresh produce with families nearby. What used to be an unpleasant space has become a place where neighbors work and learn together.

1) The garden grows vegetables in raised beds.

2) A neglected lot was transformed into a useful place that brings the community together.

3) Students enjoy learning about insects in the garden.

2. A Surprising Journey

Every autumn, monarch butterflies travel thousands of kilometers to reach warmer places. Although each butterfly is delicate, some cross mountains and large stretches of land. They rely on the position of the sun and an internal sense of direction to guide them. Along the way, they stop to drink nectar from flowers. Their long journey shows how remarkable animal migration can be.

1) Monarch butterflies drink nectar during their travels.

2) Mountains are dangerous for small insects.

3) Monarch butterflies complete an impressive seasonal migration using natural navigation skills.

3. The Library on Wheels

In several rural towns, the nearest public library is too far away for children to visit regularly. To solve this problem, a bus filled with books travels between villages each week. Children borrow stories, return books, and ask the librarian for recommendations. The bus also provides internet access for students who need to complete research projects. This traveling library makes learning resources available to communities that might otherwise struggle to reach them.

1) A traveling library helps people in remote communities access books and learning resources.

2) The library bus visits several villages every week.

3) Some children use the bus to complete school projects.

4. The Unexpected Delay

The class had planned to observe birds at the wetland on Friday morning. When they arrived, heavy rain made the walking paths unsafe. Instead of canceling the entire trip, their guide invited them into the visitor center. They studied bird feathers under magnifying glasses, listened to recordings of bird calls, and learned why

wetlands are important. By the end of the day, the students agreed that their changed plans had still led to a valuable learning experience.

1) Rain prevented the students from walking outside.

2) An unexpected change in plans can still lead to meaningful learning.

3) The students listened to recordings of bird calls.

Part B - Main Idea and Supporting Details

Read each passage. Underline the sentence that best states the main idea, if present. Circle three supporting details. Then write the main idea in your own words.

5. Saving the Shoreline

Coastal dunes may look like ordinary hills of sand, but they protect nearby communities. Strong winds push sand into ridges that slow the movement of water during storms. Grasses growing on the dunes hold the sand in place with their roots. Without these natural barriers, waves could reach roads and homes more easily. For this reason, volunteers plant native grasses and build marked pathways so visitors do not damage fragile dune plants.

Main idea in your own words:

_____

_____

6. A Different Kind of Classroom

At Riverside School, students spend one afternoon each month learning outdoors. During mathematics lessons, they measure the height of trees and compare their shadows. In science, they record changes in the weather and observe insects in their habitats. They also keep journals describing what they notice. Teachers have found that these activities help students connect classroom ideas with the world around them.

Main idea in your own words:

_____

_____

Part C - Complete the Graphic Organizers

Read each passage. Write one main idea and three different supporting details in the organizer. Avoid choosing a detail that is too narrow to be the main idea.

7. The Power of Practice

When Maya joined the school orchestra, she struggled to play the violin smoothly. Her fingers often landed on the wrong strings, and she lost her place during rehearsals. Rather than giving up, she practiced for fifteen minutes every evening. She asked her teacher for advice and listened carefully to recordings of the music. After several weeks, she could play the entire piece with confidence. Maya discovered that steady effort and helpful feedback can lead to improvement.

Main Idea
_____
_____

Supporting Detail 1	**Supporting Detail 2**	**Supporting Detail 3**
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

Part C - Complete the Graphic Organizers (continued)

8. Why Bees Matter

Bees do much more than produce honey. When they move from flower to flower collecting nectar, pollen sticks to their bodies. They carry this pollen to other flowers, helping many plants make seeds and fruit. Apples, pumpkins, and many other crops depend on pollinators. Gardens with a variety of flowering plants can provide bees with food throughout the growing season. Protecting bees helps support both wild plants and the foods people grow.

Main Idea
_____
_____

Supporting Detail 1	**Supporting Detail 2**	**Supporting Detail 3**
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

Answer Key | Set 2

Part A

1. 2) A neglected lot was transformed into a useful place that brings the community together.

2. 3) Monarch butterflies complete an impressive seasonal migration using natural navigation skills.

3. 1) A traveling library helps people in remote communities access books and learning resources.

4. 2) An unexpected change in plans can still lead to meaningful learning.

Part B - Sample Answers

5. Saving the Shoreline - Main idea: Coastal dunes protect nearby communities from storms and erosion. Supporting details: dunes slow storm water; grasses anchor sand with roots; without dunes, waves can more easily reach roads and homes.

6. A Different Kind of Classroom - Main idea: Outdoor lessons help students connect school subjects to real-world experiences. Supporting details: students measure trees and shadows; observe weather and insects; write observation journals.

Part C - Sample Answers

7. The Power of Practice - Main idea: Regular practice and guidance help people improve difficult skills. Details: Maya practiced fifteen minutes nightly; asked her teacher for advice; eventually played the entire piece confidently.

8. Why Bees Matter - Main idea: Bees are important pollinators that support plants and food crops. Details: pollen sticks to bees as they collect nectar; bees move pollen between flowers; crops such as apples and pumpkins rely on pollinators.

Accept reasonable paraphrases and other accurate, distinct supporting details.